

Assignment: Week 5: Pre-Mortem on a Hypothetical (Due: Feb 20)

Prompt

Practice the pre-mortem exercise on a project you're NOT doing.

Your task:

Choose one of the following:

- One of the scenarios from the class assignment
- A potential capstone project you decided NOT to pursue
- A hypothetical project based on your work experience

Your submission should include:

1. Project Summary

- 2-3 sentences describing the project, sponsor, and goal

2. The Pre-Mortem Narrative

- Imagine it's 6 months from now. The project failed.
- Write 2-3 paragraphs telling the story of what went wrong
- Be specific: What happened? What was the root cause?
- Include at least one of:
 - Correlation/causation confusion
 - Stakeholder dynamics gone wrong
 - Scope creep
 - Data quality issues
 - Metric gaming
 - **The data turned out to be garbage** (missing, inconsistent, or unusable)
 - **The sponsor went dark** (stopped responding, left company, lost interest)

3. What Should Have Been Done Differently?

- Looking back at your failure story, what interventions could have prevented it?
- Be specific

4. How This Informs Your Capstone

- What will you do differently in your actual capstone because of this exercise?
- What risks will you watch for?

Reflection: What did the pre-mortem reveal that you hadn't considered before writing it?

Before submitting: What decision would your capstone drive? What could break if it succeeds?